



Oreo update for Moto

Motorola released a list of their smartphones receiving the Android Oreo upgrade. Check out and see if your phone is included. <http://dgit.in/OreoMoto>



Disabling the Bixby button

With the latest update, Samsung finally lets users disable the Bixby voice assistant button on the Galaxy S8 and Note 8. <http://dgit.in/NoBixby>

Ever wondered why people seem to harbour a deep hatred for Microsoft?

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f you don't hate Microsoft, and this is the first time you're hearing about an ideology like this

existing, a) You're probably under 23 years of age and b) rest assured, you aren't the only one. While some millennials might have escaped the strange indoctrination of the "Hate M\$" ideology, older geeks might have anything ranging from a mild dislike to a full blown deep seated hatred towards Microsoft. The most peculiar aspect of this hatred is an involuntary tic. Take the very act of calling Microsoft, M\$ (<http://dgit.in/mdollar>) – a lot of us do it as an old habit learnt from the days of lurking on international tech forums. Probe a little deeper and no one really knows why. Was there any specific event or sequence of events that let to this dogma of decrying Microsoft? We decided to venture deeper down the rabbit hole.

THE BEGINNINGS

Microsoft, as a company needs no introduction. About 90% of the PCs worldwide use various versions of Windows. Hell, this whole magazine from start to finish was worked on in Windows. But ever since the company's inception in 1975, a widespread hate gradually started brewing through the PC enthusiast community. Some of it might have been due to Bill Gates' open letter to the PC hobbyists of that era. In that letter, Gates implored people to stop pirating their Altair BASIC interpreter and that it was absolute financial ruin for Microsoft if piracy continued. "The amount of royalties we have received from sales

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to hobbyists makes the time spent on Altair BASIC worth less than \$2 an hour" said a line in that now infamous letter (<http://dgit.in/gatesletr>). He also went on to say that this is basically theft. When we look back onto what actually prompted this letter, the cause is readily apparent. MITS (a yester-year's computer maker) had signed a royalty deal with Microsoft to license their Altair BASIC interpreter. MITS was selling a few thousand computers a month, but Microsoft was only able to sell barely any copies of BASIC individually due to rampant piracy. The cut they were getting from MITS was barely anything. Meanwhile, hobbyist groups like the Homebrew Club thought nothing of just copying the paper tapes containing the interpreter and passing it among themselves.

The accusations in the letter put many of the hobbyists on the defensive who felt morally wronged to be branded thieves and retaliated by lashing back at Microsoft with the reason that \$150 for a piece of code was too much, especially when piracy

was so easy. While it's easy to scratch our heads now at this logic, perhaps they felt different and undoubtedly felt justified in using a bootleg copy. This is the first clear sign of hate developing towards Microsoft which would fester over time and possibly, the start of this cult of calling Microsoft M\$.

MICROSOFT, THE MONOPOLY

Soon MITS and Microsoft had a falling out, the two companies went their separate ways. Meanwhile, in the computing world, IBM was the reigning giant and Apple was clawing its way onto the scene, while all the other competitors like the classic Commodore 64 fell by the wayside. Apple's line of Macintosh computers were better built and much easier to use (thanks mainly to the GUI while everyone used text based interfaces) but they were also a darn sight more expensive (It's funny how some things never change huh) and aimed at the more creative types. Businesses, who formed the bulk of PC purchasing audience back then didn't care much for fancy graphics and just needed